

of the ancestors of the 26 extant MSS may well have been brought to the monastery before the Islamic conquest.

The profiles of the first five MSS in the above list are **very** different, distinct from each other; none is a copy of $\aleph$, which I find to be curious. Evidently $\aleph$ was not copied—why?¹

Megistis Lavras

Well, ok, but what about M Lavras? Isn't the disproportionate percentage of f^{35} MSS suspicious? To find out we must do for M Lavras what we did for Sinai, which will be twice as much work (52 X 26). Again, I will list the MSS in a descending order of 'Alexandrishness', with the proviso that such an ordering is only relevant for the first nine or ten:

1. 1739 – X, ap ($2 = 66$ [4 subs], $1/2 = 7$, $1 = 12$ [2 subs], odd = 13) = 98;
2. 044 – VIII, ap ($2 = 52$ [1 sub], $1/2 = 7$, $1 = 20$, sing = 7, odd = 11) = 97;
3. 1735 – XI, ap ($2 = 43$ [2 subs], $1/2 = 7$ [1 sub], $1 = 35$ [2 subs], sing = 1, odd = 12) = 98;
4. 1505 – XII, eap ($2 = 41$ [3 subs], $1/2 = 4$, $1 = 35$ [3 subs], odd = 18) = 98;
5. 1448 – XI, eap ($2 = 23$, $1/2 = 7$ [1 sub], $1 = 58$ [2 subs], sing = 1, odd = 8) = 97;
6. 1490 – XII, eap ($2 = 13$, $1/2 = 7$ [1 sub], $1 = 69$ [4 subs], odd = 9) = 98;
7. 1751 – 1479, ap ($2 = 7$ [1 sub], $1/2 = 11$ [1 sub], $1 = 69$ [3 subs], sing = 5, odd = 6) = 98;
8. 1501 – XIII, eap ($2 = 8$ [1 sub], $1/2 = 8$, $1 = 73$ [1 sub], sing = 1, odd = 8) = 98;
9. 1661 – XV, eap ($2 = 6$, $1/2 = 9$ [1 sub], $1 = 73$ [5 subs], sing = 3, odd = 7) = 98;

From here on down all the MSS fall within the Byzantine stream.

10. 1609 – XIV, eap ($2 = 9$ [1 sub], $1/2 = 9$, $1 = 76$ [4 subs], odd = 3) =

¹ But over ten people did try to correct it, down through the centuries, so they knew it was there. 1243 and 1241 are almost as bad, and they were produced in the 11th and 12th centuries, respectively.